

Parent Guidance — Design Guidelines

Design system of the PG-Live prototype · Updated October 1, 2026

Guidelines for the **PG-Live** prototype (parentguidance.org), written from the **prototype's real code** (`src/app`) and organized with the method of Scalar's design system.

- **The visual identity** (colors, typography, radii, shadows, buttons and animation) comes from what the prototype already used: the most repeated values became tokens and the one-off values were consolidated.
- **The method** comes from Scalar: everything comes from tokens, closed scales, button hierarchy, accessibility and a reduced-motion contract.

Status: the prototype already follows these guidelines (final audit in [section 5.6](#)). Every new screen or component must follow them from the start.

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4	Motion	Animation with <code>motion</code> , durations, easing and reduced-motion
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PDF version: `docs/guidelines/pdf/` has one PDF per guide plus one with all of them (`Parent-Guidance-Design-Guidelines-complete.pdf`). They are generated from these `.md` files; when a guide changes, they need to be generated again. The Spanish version lives in `docs/guidelines/` and its PDFs in `docs/guidelines/pdf/es/`.

Where everything lives

File	What it is
<code>src/styles/tokens.css</code>	CSS variables (<code>--pg-*</code>) and their Tailwind v4 mapping (<code>bg-pg-navy</code> , <code>rounded-pg-md</code> , <code>shadow-pg-card</code> , <code>max-w-pg-page</code> ...)
<code>src/styles/accessibility.css</code>	Global visible focus and the reduced-motion rule
<code>src/app/components/Button.tsx</code>	<code><Button></code> , <code><ButtonLink></code> , <code><ButtonAnchor></code> and <code>buttonClass()</code>
<code>src/app/components/UnifiedCard.tsx</code>	Standard card (resources, courses, help lines)
<code>src/app/mhs/EventModal.tsx</code>	Event pop-up (accessible dialog pattern)
<code>guidelines/Guidelines.md</code>	Short summary for Figma Make (the file its AI reads when generating screens)

Visual personality

Parent Guidance supports families through sensitive topics (mental health, crisis, parenting). The interface must feel **warm, calm and trustworthy**:

- Warm cream background, deep navy text and teal/sage accents.
- Soft shapes: rounded corners, subtle navy-tinted shadows, never hard black ones.
- Calm motion: short, gentle entrances, nothing that bounces or blinks.
- Readability first: the audience is parents, often on their phones and under stress.

What we took from Scalar and what we didn't

Adopted (the method):

- Token rule: no hex, size or shadow written "by hand"; everything comes from `tokens.css` .
- Closed type and spacing scales; any new value is assigned the nearest step.
- Button hierarchy: one Primary per section, labels that start with a verb, complete states (Focus, Loading, Disabled), 44px minimum touch area.
- Grids that degrade in steps (3 → 2 → 1 columns).
- Safe, unhurried motion with duration bands and a mandatory reduced-motion contract.

Discarded:

- Scalar's blue palette ( `#037de8` ...) and the Inter typeface: Parent Guidance has its own brand.
- Scalar's 1160px container: the prototype uses 1280px.
- GSAP/ScrollTrigger, parallax, marquee, spotlight bento and the "Living Model" diagram: they don't fit a website that supports families, and the prototype already uses `motion` .

Rule #1

No color, font size, radius or shadow is written as a loose value (`text-[#1c3243]` , `text-[13px]` , `shadow-[...]` , `text-gray-700`). Use the tokens in `tokens.css` . If something is missing, first add it as a token here (and in Figma), then use it.

Accepted exceptions: colors inside SVG logos (brand art), course category palettes (data colors) and reading widths of hero text (`max-w-[480px]` ...).

How to check a screen

1. Review it at **390, 768, 1024 and 1280px**: no horizontal scroll and no squeezed text.
2. Go through it with the keyboard (Tab, Enter, Esc): everything clickable can be reached and shows focus.
3. AA contrast on all text (table in [section 1.1](#)).
4. Buttons use the component, headings follow the scale, no bouncing animations.

Foundations

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Every value lives in `tokens.css` as a CSS variable (`--pg-navy`) and as a Tailwind class (`bg-pg-navy` , `text-pg-slate` ...). In inline styles or `motion` props, use the variable: `style={{ boxShadow: "var(--pg-shadow-card)" }}` , `animate={{ backgroundColor: "var(--pg-teal)" }}` .

1.1 Palette

Brand

Token	Hex	Tailwind	Use
Navy	 <code>#1c3243</code>	<code>pg-navy</code>	Headings, primary text, navigation, dark backgrounds, active chip
Navy hover	 <code>#284054</code>	<code>pg-navy-hover</code>	Hover on navy elements
Slate	 <code>#435766</code>	<code>pg-slate</code>	Body text, descriptions, interface icons
Teal	 <code>#59797d</code>	<code>pg-teal</code>	Action color: Primary buttons, links, active icons, selection ring
Teal dark	 <code>#406064</code>	<code>pg-teal-dark</code>	Hover/pressed for teal actions; small accent text (eyebrows, links, metadata)
Sage	 <code>#90b3b6</code>	<code>pg-sage</code>	Decorative accent: color blocks, section-title side bar, large icons, search icons
Mist	 <code>#acbcbe</code>	<code>pg-mist</code>	Decorative elements only ("•" separators with <code>aria-hidden</code> , inactive dots). Never text
Amber	 <code>#c8893a</code>	<code>pg-amber</code>	Lesson accent; decorative fill only
Live	 <code>#52bd95</code>	<code>pg-live</code>	"Live" dot; decorative only

Surfaces and borders

Token	Hex	Tailwind	Use
Cream	 <code>#f9f4f1</code>	<code>pg-cream</code>	Default page background; search fields on white bars
Cream dark	 <code>#f0edeb</code>	<code>pg-cream-dark</code>	Inactive chips, "Featured" button, dividers on cream
White	 <code>#ffffff</code>	<code>white</code>	Cards, panels, filter bars, inputs
Tint	 <code>#eaf1f1</code>	<code>pg-tint</code>	Soft surfaces: badges, date blocks, selected state

Token	Hex	Tailwind	Use
Tint soft	 #f0f6f6	pg-tint-soft	Background of listing sections; row hover
Line	 #dee8e9	pg-line	Borders of cards and inputs, dividers

States

Used in badges, notices and validation. They meet AA on white and cream.

State	Text / icon	Soft background	Where it is used
Success	 #2f7a5f pg-success	 #e6f2ec pg-success-soft	"Guide" badge (with navy text)
Warning	 #8a5a1c pg-warning	 #f7eddc pg-warning-soft	"Worksheet" badge, Ask a Therapist legal notice
Error	 #b42318 pg-error	 #fdecea pg-error-soft	"Tool" badge, form errors

`pg-success` on `pg-success-soft` gives 4.49:1: for small text use **navy** on the green background and keep green for the icon.

Approved contrast combinations

Text	Background	Ratio	Allowed for
Navy	White / Cream / Tint / Line / Sage	5.9–13.2	Everything
Slate	White / Cream / Tint	6.6–7.5	Everything
Teal	White	4.7	Everything
Teal	Cream / Tint	4.1–4.3	Only text ≥ 18px or ≥ 14px bold; for small text use Teal dark
Teal dark	White / Cream / Tint	6.0–6.8	Everything
White	Teal / Teal dark / Navy	4.7 / 6.8 / 13.2	Everything (buttons, badges, dark blocks)
Sage	Navy	5.9	Secondary text and accents on dark backgrounds
Sage / Mist	White / Cream	2.0–2.3	Never as text
White	Sage	2.3	Never: on sage, text and badges are navy

Highlighted blocks

A banner or CTA **inside** a section must stand out from its background: `pg-sage` (navy text, Inverse button), `pg-navy` (white or sage text, Inverse button) or a white card with a `pg-line` border and the

card shadow. Never `pg-tint` on `pg-tint-soft` or `pg-cream-dark` on `pg-cream` (1.04:1, the block disappears).

1.2 Typography

Poppins is the only typeface (400, 500, 600 and 700). It is applied once on `body` (`tokens.css`) and every element inherits it, including buttons and inputs: **do not add font classes**. No `font-black` or `font-light` either: Poppins is only loaded in 400–700.

Scale

Token	Mobile → desktop	Tailwind	Weight	Use
<code>display</code>	38 → 50px	<code>text-[38px]</code> <code>md:text-[50px]</code>	700	Main headline of the home pages (one per page)
<code>h1</code>	28 → 40px	<code>text-[28px]</code> <code>md:text-[40px]</code>	700 (500 in V2)	Page title; titles of featured sections with a colored background ("Need Help Now?", "Join Us!")
<code>h2</code>	24px	<code>text-2xl</code>	700	Section title, banners
<code>h3</code>	20px	<code>text-xl</code>	600–700	Block and panel titles, section labels with a sage bar ("Resource Library"), FAQ questions
<code>h4</code>	16px	<code>text-base</code>	700	Card title
<code>body-lg</code>	16px	<code>text-base</code>	400	Introductions and featured paragraphs
<code>body</code>	14px	<code>text-sm</code>	400	Default text , buttons, inputs
<code>small</code>	12px	<code>text-xs</code>	400–600	Metadata, captions, chips, field hints
<code>eyebrow</code>	11px	<code>text-[11px]</code> <code>uppercase</code>	600	Kicker above headings, date labels ("JUL")

Rules:

- **12px minimum**; 11px only for UPPERCASE text (eyebrows, months in date blocks).
- No in-between sizes outside the scale (13, 15, 18, 22, 30, 36px...): use the nearest step.
- Brand emphasis in headlines: one word or phrase in teal *italics* ("Discover *Resources...*"), without changing the size.
- About 70 characters per line maximum in long paragraphs (`max-w-pg-reading` , 680px).

1.3 Spacing

Tailwind's 4px scale is used. Allowed steps:

Tailwind	px	Typical use
<code>1</code> / <code>1.5</code>	4 / 6	Icon ↔ small text

Tailwind	px	Typical use
2	8	Gap between inline elements, icon ↔ label, between chips
3	12	Gap in compact lists and filter bars
4	16	Card padding, gap between fields
5 / 6	20 / 24	Panel padding, grid gap, mobile gutter
8	32	Space between blocks
10 / 14	40 / 56	Page side gutter (md / lg)
14 / 16 / 20	56 / 64 / 80	Section vertical padding

Avoid loose in-between values (`py-3.5` , `px-2.5`) except for optical adjustments inside components.

1.4 Radii

Token	Value	Tailwind	Use
sm	4px	<code>rounded-pg-sm</code>	Checkboxes, minimal elements
md	8px	<code>rounded-pg-md</code>	Buttons , inputs, selects, "Featured" button
lg	12px	<code>rounded-pg-lg</code>	Small panels, dropdown menus, date blocks
xl	16px	<code>rounded-pg-xl</code>	Cards , pop-ups, banners
2xl	28px	<code>rounded-pg-2xl</code>	Heroes, featured video, section blocks with a background
full	9999px	<code>rounded-full</code>	Chips, badges, avatars, dots, pill-shaped search bars

In the shadcn theme `rounded-lg` is 10px and `rounded-xl` 14px, so the `rounded-pg-*` tokens are always used.

1.5 Shadows

Every shadow is **navy-tinted** (`rgba(28,50,67,...)`), never black.

Token	Value	Use
card	<code>0 8px 24px rgba(28,50,67,0.06)</code>	Cards, filter bars, selected controls
card-hover	<code>0 8px 24px rgba(28,50,67,0.14)</code>	Interactive cards on hover; navbar on scroll
overlay	<code>0 24px 60px rgba(28,50,67,0.28)</code>	Pop-ups, modals, floating menus

Cards use a `pg-line border + card shadow`. To make something stand out, don't stack stronger shadows: use the background color (tint, sage or navy).

1.6 Icons

- Library: **lucide-react**, 14–16px in controls and 18–20px in icon-only buttons.
- Color via `currentColor` plus a text class (`text-pg-slate` , `text-pg-sage` ...), never a hex in the SVG.
- Decorative icons get `aria-hidden="true"` ; icon-only buttons get an `aria-label` .
- Exception: SVG logos (Parent Guidance, partners, social networks) keep their brand colors.

Buttons

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Every action button in the prototype comes from a single system, built from the most repeated button in the original design (the `UnifiedCard` one: teal, 8px, Poppins semibold 14px, teal dark on hover) and implemented in the `Button.tsx` component (section 2.4).

2.1 Styles

Style	Look	When
Primary	<code>pg-teal</code> background, white text; <code>pg-teal-dark</code> on hover	The main action of the section: "View course", "Book a session", "Submit question"
Secondary	White background, 1px <code>pg-teal</code> border, <code>pg-teal-dark</code> text; <code>pg-tint</code> background on hover	Supporting action next to a Primary ("Cancel", "View details")
Tertiary	<code>pg-teal-dark</code> text only, underlined on hover	Low-priority actions: "See more", "Skip"
Inverse	White background, <code>pg-navy</code> text; <code>pg-cream</code> on hover	Main action on navy, teal or sage backgrounds
Inverse secondary	<code>white/5</code> background, <code>white/20</code> border, white text; <code>white/10</code> on hover	Supporting action on dark backgrounds

One Primary per section. If there are more actions, they become Secondary or Tertiary.

There are no navy or sage buttons: navy is the color of text and navigation, not of action. That way users learn that teal means "I can click this".

On a **sage** background (banners such as "Not sure which resource is right for you?") the main action is **Inverse**: teal on sage is barely visible.

2.2 Sizes

Size	Height	Padding	Text	When
S	36px	<code>px-4</code>	14px / 600	Dense UI: toolbars, pagination, "Register" in event rows. On mobile, only if the button is full width
M	44px	<code>px-5</code>	14px / 600	Default

Size	Height	Padding	Text	When
L	52px	px-7	16px / 600	Hero CTAs and key screens on mobile

- `rounded-pg-md` radius (8px) on every size.
- The **pill** shape (`rounded-full`) is reserved for chips, badges, filters and the search bar. Not for action buttons.
- Optional icon on the right (`→` arrow or 16px lucide icon) with `gap-2` . If the icon is decorative, it gets `aria-hidden="true"` .
- `w-full` only inside cards or on mobile.

2.3 States

State	Primary	Secondary
Default	<code>bg-pg-teal text-white</code>	<code>bg-white border-pg-teal text-pg-teal-dark</code>
Hover	<code>bg-pg-teal-dark</code>	<code>bg-pg-tint</code>
Pressed	<code>scale 0.97</code> (motion <code>whileTap</code>)	same
Focus	2px <code>pg-teal-dark</code> ring with a 2px offset	same
Loading	16px spinner + "Sending...", <code>aria-busy="true"</code> , no clicks	same
Disabled	<code>bg-pg-line text-pg-slate</code> , <code>not-allowed</code> cursor	<code>border-pg-line text-pg-slate</code>

Visible focus is applied globally in `src/styles/accessibility.css` : every link, button or field shows a 2px teal dark ring with a white halo when navigating with the keyboard, on light and dark backgrounds. New components don't need to add focus classes.

2.4 Component

The prototype's buttons use `src/app/components/Button.tsx` :

Component	For	Example
<code><Button></code>	Actions (submit, open, download)	<code><Button variant="secondary" size="s" onClick={...}>Today</Button></code>
<code><ButtonLink></code>	Navigation inside the app (<code>react-router</code>)	<code><ButtonLink to="/ask-a-therapist">View Answer</ButtonLink></code>
<code><ButtonAnchor></code>	External links, <code>mailto:</code> , <code>tel:</code> , <code>sms:</code> and <code>#</code> anchors	<code><ButtonAnchor href="tel:988" variant="inverse" size="l">Call 988</ButtonAnchor></code>
<code>buttonClass()</code>	Just the classes, for elements that can't use the components	<code>className={buttonClass({ variant: "secondary" })}</code>

- Props: `variant` (`primary` by default, `secondary`, `tertiary`, `inverse`, `inverse-secondary`) and `size` (`s`, `m` by default, `l`). `<Button>` also accepts `loading` .
- They all have `whileTap={{ scale: 0.97 }}` and no `whileHover` scaling; hover changes color only.
- `className` is for layout (`w-full`, `mt-4`, `shrink-0`), not for changing colors, radii or sizes.
- Exception: the "Search" button inside a pill-shaped search bar may use `rounded-full`, because it is part of the bar.
- In newsletters, the button sits **inside** the input box (with `p-1.5` and `gap-2`), not glued to its edge.

Controls that are not action buttons

These elements have their own style and do **not** use `<Button>` :

Control	Style
Filter chips	<code>rounded-full text-xs font-medium px-4 py-2</code> ; active <code>bg-pg-navy text-white</code> , inactive <code>bg-pg-cream-dark text-pg-slate</code> , with <code>aria-pressed</code>
"Featured" (sort) menu	<code>rounded-pg-md bg-pg-cream-dark text-xs font-medium px-4 py-2.5</code> , 14px lucide <code>ListFilter</code> + <code>ChevronDown</code> icons, centered with the label
Segmented control (Month/List, Day/Week/Month)	<code>bg-pg-tint-soft</code> container; active option is white with <code>shadow-pg-card</code> and <code>aria-pressed</code>
Numeric pagination	36–44px squares; current page in navy or teal; Prev/Next as <code><Button variant="secondary" size="s"></code>
Icon-only buttons	36–44px, <code>rounded-pg-md</code> , <code>aria-label</code> required (calendar arrows, close, menu)

2.5 Accessibility

- Use `<button>` for actions and `<a>` for navigation. Never `<div onClick>` .
- Minimum touch area of **44×44px** on mobile (size M or L).
- External links (`target="_blank"`) must say so: an external-link icon + hidden text "(opens in a new tab)".
- Icon-only buttons get an `aria-label` ("Close", "Menu").
- Disabled: explain why with nearby helper text if it isn't obvious.
- On the **Get Help** page (crisis lines), call/text buttons use `<a href="tel:...">` and `<a href="sms:...">` in size L, so they are easy to tap in a moment of stress.

2.6 Do / Don't

Do

- One Primary per section, in teal.
- Short labels that start with a verb: "View course", "Book a session".
- The same size for every button in a row.

Don't

- Navy, sage or mist buttons.
- Mixing pill and rectangular buttons on the same screen.
- `whileHover` scaling above 1.02 on buttons: it feels unstable.
- Button text at 10–11px.

Layout

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3.1 Containers

Token	Width	Tailwind	Use
<code>page</code>	1280px	<code>max-w-pg-page</code>	Default container: navigation, sections, filter bars, card grids, Mental Health Series
<code>content</code>	1100px	<code>max-w-pg-content</code>	Topic and event pages, centered banners
<code>reading</code>	680px	<code>max-w-pg-reading</code>	Long text: legal pages, articles, single-column forms

Hero text may limit its reading width with `max-w-[480px]` or similar; those are not containers.

Side margins (gutter)

```
<section className="px-6 md:px-10 lg:px-14">
  <div className="max-w-pg-page mx-auto">...</div>
</section>
```

- Mobile: 24px · Tablet (≥ 768): 40px · Desktop (≥ 1024): 56px.
- The section background runs edge to edge; the content is centered inside it.
- If a section has few elements (e.g. image + newsletter), the group is **centered** inside the container (`lg:justify-center`) instead of sticking to the left.

3.2 Breakpoints

Tailwind's breakpoints are used. The rule of thumb: **mobile and tablet stack; columns start at `lg`**.

Prefix	From	What changes
(base)	0	One column, 24px gutter, mobile-size headings, ☰ menu
<code>sm</code>	640px	Card grids go to 2 columns; row buttons sit next to the content
<code>md</code>	768px	Desktop-size headings, 40px gutter, filter bars on a single row
<code>lg</code>	1024px	Full navigation , 2-column heroes, sidebars on detail and lesson pages, footer in rows, 3–4 column grids

Prefix	From	What changes
xl	1280px	Fine adjustments (3 columns of questions in Ask a Therapist); the container is already at its maximum

Degrade in steps (Scalar principle): 4 → 2 → 1 or 3 → 2 → 1 columns, never straight from 4 to 1.

Anything with a large fixed width (248–300px sidebars, 420–480px images) applies it only from `lg` (`w-full lg:w-[300px]`). On tablet, fixed widths were what caused horizontal scroll.

3.3 Vertical rhythm

Context	Mobile → desktop	Tailwind
Standard section	56 → 80px	<code>py-14 md:py-20</code>
Compact section (listings, filters)	40 → 56px	<code>py-10 md:py-14</code>
Page hero	96px on top (fixed 56px navbar)	<code>pt-24 pb-14</code>
Section title → content	24–32px	<code>mb-6 / mb-8</code>
Between cards in a grid	16–20px	<code>gap-4 / gap-5</code>
Inside a card	16–20px	<code>p-4 / p-5</code>

Sections alternate by **background color** (cream → white → tint-soft → navy) instead of divider lines. For highlighted blocks inside a section, see [Highlighted blocks](#).

3.4 Grid patterns

Pattern	Classes	Use
Resource cards	<code>grid-cols-1 sm:grid-cols-2 lg:grid-cols-3</code> (or <code>lg:grid-cols-4</code>) <code>gap-4/5</code>	Resource Library, home pages, a topic's resources
Courses	<code>grid-cols-1 md:grid-cols-2 xl:grid-cols-3 gap-4</code>	On-Demand Courses
Questions with sidebar	<code>grid-cols-1 sm:grid-cols-2 xl:grid-cols-3 gap-5</code>	Ask a Therapist
Detail + sidebar	<code>flex flex-col lg:flex-row gap-6</code> ; sidebar <code>w-full lg:w-[280px] - [300px]</code> , <code>lg:sticky</code>	Course, lesson, question
Text + image (hero)	<code>grid grid-cols-1 lg:grid-cols-2 gap-10 items-center</code>	Coaching, Courses and Get Help heroes
Benefits / steps	<code>grid-cols-1 sm:grid-cols-2 lg:grid-cols-4</code>	Navy band and steps on Parent Coaching
Help lines	<code>grid-cols-1 md:grid-cols-2 xl:grid-cols-3 gap-5</code>	Get Help
Topic + sidebar	<code>grid-cols-1 lg:grid-cols-[1fr_340px] gap-8 lg:gap-14</code>	Mental Health Series topic page

3.5 Patterns

Standard card (UnifiedCard)

- White background, `rounded-pg-xl`, `pg-line` border, `card` shadow.
- 150px-tall image on top (`object-cover`, or `object-contain` with padding for logos).
- Content with `p-4 : navy` `h4` title, slate `small` description, teal dark `small` metadata.
- Full-width Primary button anchored at the bottom (`mt-auto`), so every card in a row aligns its button.
- Destination: `to` (internal route, `<Link>`), `href` (external, new tab) or `onClick` .
- Optional badge: navy pill with white text in the top-left corner.

Color variant (home): bottom block in `pg-sage` with `pg-navy` text. Hover on clickable cards: `card-hover` shadow and at most `y: -2` . No card scaling.

Until a section has its own detail pages, its cards link to a **sample page** (courses alternate the Milestones and Free Yourself templates; resources open "Building Your Child's Confidence").

Filter bar

Same pattern on On-Demand Courses, Ask a Therapist and Mental Health Series:

```
<div className="bg-white border-y border-pg-line sticky top-14 z-30 shadow-pg-card">
  <div className="max-w-pg-page mx-auto px-6 md:px-10 py-3 flex flex-wrap md:flex-nowrap items-center gap-3 md:gap-4">
    {/* search: relative min-w-0 flex-1 md:flex-none md:w-64; input bg-pg-cream rounded-pg-md py-2.5, text-pg-sage magnifier */}
    {/* chips: order-last basis-full md:order-none md:basis-auto flex-1 min-w-0 overflow-x-auto gap-2 */}
    {/* "Featured": sort menu on the right */}
  </div>
</div>
```

- Full width, below the hero, and **sticky under the navigation** while browsing the list it filters (if the page continues with other content, the bar sits inside the listing block so it releases at the end).
- One bar per listing: search and chips are never repeated further down.
- On mobile: search + "Featured" on top, chips on their own scrollable row.

Section title with a count

4×20px sage bar + navy `h3` title + count pill `bg-pg-tint text-pg-teal-dark text-xs` ("Resource Library · 9 resources", "Browse All · 15 questions").

Newsletter

The button sits inside the input box: `flex items-center gap-2 rounded-pg-xl bg-pg-tint-soft p-1.5` (on navy, the box is `bg-pg-navy-hover` and the button is Inverse).

Event pop-up / dialogs

`EventModal` : 320px card with a teal header, `rounded-pg-xl` , `shadow-pg-overlay` . Next to the element that opens it on desktop, centered on mobile. `role="dialog"` with `aria-modal` , trapped focus, closes with Esc, the X or a click outside, and returns focus when closed.

Video

Vimeo videos use an `iframe` in `aspect-video` , `rounded-pg-2xl` (featured) or `rounded-pg-xl` (cards), with a descriptive `title` , `allow="autoplay; fullscreen; picture-in-picture"` and `dnst=1` in the URL. The Mental Health Series welcome video loads the player directly; topic page videos show a thumbnail and load the player on click.

3.6 Navigation

- Fixed 56px navy navbar (`h-14`); the logo always links to the home page.
- From `lg` , full links; below it, a `≡` button opens the menu (closes with Esc, an outside tap or on navigation) and returns focus.
- Every new page opens at the top (`ScrollRestoration`); back/forward restores the position.

3.7 Checklist for a new screen

1. `pg-cream` background, `max-w-pg-page` container with a `px-6 md:px-10 lg:px-14` gutter.
2. A single `display` (home pages only) or `h1` per page.
3. Sections with `py-14 md:py-20` , alternating the background color.
4. Grid from table 3.4, degrading in steps; fixed widths only from `lg` .
5. Cards with `UnifiedCard` ; listings with the standard filter bar.
6. One teal Primary per section; buttons with `<Button>` .
7. Review at **390, 768, 1024 and 1280px**.

Motion

Design guidelines · Parent Guidance · Updated October 1, 2026

The prototype animates with `motion` (Framer Motion, `motion/react`). Scalar principle: **safe, unhurried** motion, never bouncy, and always respecting reduced-motion.

4.1 Tokens

Durations and curves live in `tokens.css`:

Band	Duration	CSS variable	Tailwind class	Use
Micro	0.15s	<code>--pg-dur-micro</code>	<code>duration-(--pg-dur-micro)</code>	Press, color change, sort menus
Fast	0.22s	<code>--pg-dur-fast</code>	<code>duration-(--pg-dur-fast)</code>	Hover, icons, pop-ups
Base	0.35s	<code>--pg-dur-base</code>	<code>duration-(--pg-dur-base)</code>	Accordions, menus, modals, view changes
Reveal	0.55s	<code>--pg-dur-reveal</code>	<code>duration-(--pg-dur-reveal)</code>	Content entrance on scroll

Curve	Value	Use
<code>ease-pg-out</code>	<code>[0.25, 0.46, 0.45, 0.94]</code>	Brand curve: entrances, reveals, pop-ups
<code>ease-pg-in-out</code>	<code>[0.65, 0, 0.35, 1]</code>	Open/close, accordions, tabs

In `motion` props, write the numbers (`transition={{ duration: 0.55, ease: [0.25, 0.46, 0.45, 0.94] }}`). Stagger between cards in a grid: **0.06s**, for the first 6 items only.

4.2 Patterns

Reveal on scroll

Used gently and **only once**:

```
<motion.div
  initial={{ opacity: 0, y: 16 }}
  whileInView={{ opacity: 1, y: 0 }}
  viewport={{ once: true, margin: "-60px" }}
  transition={{ duration: 0.55, ease: [0.25, 0.46, 0.45, 0.94] }}
/>
```

- Vertical offset of **16–24px**. Horizontal offsets (`x`) only in heroes and image + text rows, 32–48px at most, and a page that uses them gets `overflow-x-clip` so it doesn't create horizontal scroll on mobile.
- Always `once: true` : content doesn't hide again when scrolling up.
- Grids: `delay: index * 0.06` , for the first 6 items only.

Interaction feedback

Element	Animation
Buttons (<code><Button></code>)	<code>whileTap={{ scale: 0.97 }}</code> + color with <code>transition-colors</code> . Hover changes color only
Clickable cards	Hover: <code>card-hover</code> shadow and <code>y: -2</code> . No scaling
Featured images	Hover: 1.02 maximum scale (or no animation)
Social icons	Hover: <code>y: -2</code> , no scaling
Accordion / FAQ	<code>auto</code> height + opacity, 0.35s; the <code>+</code> icon rotates 45°
Pop-ups and modals	Backdrop fades; panel <code>opacity 0 → 1</code> , <code>scale 0.97 → 1</code> , <code>y: -6 → 0</code> , 0.22s
Confirmations ("✓ Question Submitted")	<code>opacity 0 → 1</code> , <code>scale 0.9 → 1</code> , 0.35s, <code>ease-pg-out</code>

What to avoid

- Bouncy `type: "spring"` .
- `whileHover` scaling above 1.02.
- `whileHover` color changes in `motion` : use Tailwind `hover:` classes.
- Infinite or decorative animations. The only exception is the "live" dot (soft pulse), and only while that state is active.
- Entrance animations on the **Get Help** page: crisis content is visible from the very first moment (`initial={false}`).
- Animating the hero or the first visible block in a way that makes the page look empty on load.

4.3 Scrolling

- Every navigation opens the new page at the top (`<ScrollRestoration />` in the root layout); back/forward restores the position.
- "Back to top" buttons and page changes use `scrollBehavior()` from `src/app/utils/motion.ts` : `"smooth"` , or `"auto"` when the user asks for reduced motion.

4.4 Reduced-motion contract (mandatory)

Implemented. The app is wrapped in `MotionConfig` :

```
// src/app/App.tsx
<MotionConfig reducedMotion="user">{ /* ...app... */ }</MotionConfig>
```

With `reducedMotion="user"`, `motion` turns off movement and scaling for anyone who has the system setting enabled, and keeps opacity changes. CSS transitions are turned off by the `@media (prefers-reduced-motion: reduce)` rule in `accessibility.css`.

Rule: **no content may stay hidden** (`opacity: 0`) if the animation doesn't run.

Prototype audit

Design guidelines · Parent Guidance · Updated October 1, 2026

Record of the review of `src/app` (excluding `components/ui`, the shadcn base components) against these guidelines: what was found, how it was fixed and what is still pending (section 5.7).

5.1 Accessibility (high priority)

Issue	Where	Fix
✓ No visible focus styles	All buttons and links	Fixed with a global rule in <code>src/styles/accessibility.css</code>
✓ Reduced-motion not respected	Whole app	Fixed: <code>MotionConfig</code> in <code>App.tsx</code> , CSS rule in <code>accessibility.css</code> and non-animated scrolling in <code>utils/motion.ts</code>
✓ Home cards not reachable with the keyboard	Home, V1 and V2	Fixed: cards are links and FAQs are buttons with <code>aria-expanded</code>
✓ Sage <code>#90b3b6</code> text on light backgrounds	41 uses	Fixed: now teal dark <code>#406064</code> . Sage stays on navy, where it passes (5.9:1)
✓ Mist <code>#acbcbe</code> text	36 texts and 11 placeholders	Fixed: text → slate <code>#435766</code> ; all placeholders → teal <code>#59797d</code>
✓ 9-11px text	75 uses	Fixed: everything at 12px, except uppercase eyebrows, which stay at 11px
✓ <code>#9aa4ac</code> text (2.5:1)	UnifiedCard footer	Fixed: slate
✓ Small teal <code>#59797d</code> on cream or tints (3.9-4.3:1)	39 texts (eyebrows, chips, breadcrumbs, links)	Fixed: teal dark <code>#406064</code>
✓ White text on sage (2.3:1)	Step numbers, avatars	Fixed: navy on sage (5.9:1)
✓ "Learn More" sage on sage (1:1, invisible)	Home cards	Fixed: navy
✓ White "Next Lesson" button on amber (3.0:1)	Lessons	Fixed: now a teal Primary
✓ Low-contrast "-" separators	Course detail	Fixed: decorative in <code>pg-mist</code> with <code>aria-hidden</code>
✓ Testimonials in 3 columns on mobile	Parent Coaching	Fixed: 1 column up to 1024px, 3 columns on desktop

Issue	Where	Fix
✓ Navigation doesn't fit on mobile	Header	Fixed: ☰ menu below 1024px (closes with Esc, an outside tap or on navigation)
✓ Footer overflows on mobile	All pages	Fixed: stacked columns on mobile
✓ Home overflows on mobile	Home	Fixed: wrapping title, 2×2 cards, stacked image + text rows and FAQ
✓ Horizontal scroll and broken layouts on mobile and tablet	All pages	Fixed: no horizontal scroll at 390/768/1024/1280px (fixed widths only from <code>lg</code>)

5.2 Off-palette colors ✓

Fixed. The ~1,140 hex color classes (90 distinct values) now use the `pg-*` tokens. Off-palette tones were consolidated like this:

Before	Now
#1b1139 , #2c3e50 , #0d1b2a , #363049 , #293a41 , #1a2838 , #172c3a	<code>pg-navy</code>
#58595b , #333 , #6c777f , #737373	<code>pg-slate</code>
#6f9296 , #76979a , #7da3a6 , #7a9ea0 , #6d8c94 / #4a6b6f	<code>pg-teal</code> / <code>pg-teal-dark</code>
#97b4b5 , #a1bfb9	<code>pg-sage</code>
#e8f1f1 , #dceced , #edf5f5	<code>pg-tint</code>
Neutral grays (#f5f5f5 , #f0f0f0 , #fafafa ...) and #eef3f3	<code>pg-tint-soft</code>
Gray borders (#e8ebed , #dde0e0 , #e0e0e0 ...)	<code>pg-line</code>
Warm dividers (#ebe8e5 , #f1eeee ...)	<code>pg-cream-dark</code>
#c8893a / #52bd95	new <code>pg-amber</code> / <code>pg-live</code> tokens (decorative only)
#6b5c8d / #f0edf7 ("Guide" badge)	<code>pg-success</code> icon on <code>pg-success-soft</code> , <code>pg-navy</code> text

Intentionally kept as hex: colors inside SVG logos (brand art), course and topic category palettes (data colors) and values inside animation props (`whileHover`), which already use palette values.

5.3 Consistency

Topic	Status
✓ Radii	27 variants → <code>rounded-pg-sm/md/lg/xl/2xl</code> tokens (4/8/12/16/28px) and <code>rounded-full</code>
✓ Shadows	30 recipes (classes and inline) → <code>shadow-pg-card</code> , <code>shadow-pg-card-hover</code> , <code>shadow-pg-overlay</code>
✓ Containers	1280/1180 → <code>max-w-pg-page</code> ; 1100/1024/1000 → <code>max-w-pg-content</code> ; 680 → <code>max-w-pg-reading</code>
✓ Durations	16 values → 4 bands (0.15 / 0.22 / 0.35 / 0.55 s); <code>duration-(--pg-dur-*)</code> classes in CSS
✓ shadow theme	<code>tokens.css</code> maps <code>--primary</code> , <code>--ring</code> , <code>--border</code> ... to the PG palette
✓ Buttons	~45 action buttons in 17 files → <code><Button></code> , <code><ButtonLink></code> and <code><ButtonAnchor></code> (<u>Buttons</u>): 8px, 36/44/52 heights, no navy or sage, no pills
✓ Typeface	The 428 <code>font-['Poppins', sans-serif]</code> classes were removed: Poppins is applied once on <code>body</code> (<code>tokens.css</code>)

5.4 Other

- ✓ Removed from `src/imports`: the parentguidance.org screen captures, unused images (`QB_united.png`, `ADD0.png`, `image.png` ...), the unused Figma Make component `CreateLivePrototypeWithTransitions/index.tsx` and `pasted_text`: the folder went from 38 MB to 8.8 MB.
- ✓ The `<title>` and description in `index.html` now talk about Parent Guidance.
- There are two versions of the home page (`HomePageV1`, `HomePageV2`) in addition to the main one. Still to decide which one stays (5.7).

5.5 Migration (completed)

- ✓ Import `tokens.css` (done, in `src/styles/`).
- ✓ `MotionConfig` `reducedMotion="user"` and focus styles (done).
- ✓ Fix contrast: sage, mist and 9–11px sizes (done).
- ✓ Unify buttons into one component (done).
- ✓ Replace loose hex values with `pg-*` classes and consolidate radii, shadows, widths and durations (done).

5.6 Final audit ✓

Review of the `src/app` code and the 21 screens in the browser (390, 768, 1024 and 1280px).

Topic	Result
Colors	No hex in classes. Inline shadows and borders use <code>var(--pg-shadow-*)</code> and <code>var(--pg-line)</code> ; black shadows became the system's navy ones and the <code>rgb(34,49,67)</code> gradient became <code>pg-navy</code>
Typography	Every size on the scale: 13 → 14, 15 → 16, 18 → 20 (titles) or 16 (paragraphs), 22 → 24; page and featured-section titles in h1 28/40; <code>display 38/50</code> only on the home pages. <code>font-black</code> → <code>font-bold</code> . 11px text is only uppercase eyebrows
Radii and shadows	Only <code>rounded-pg-*</code> / <code>shadow-pg-*</code> tokens (the remaining Tailwind classes belong to <code>components/ui</code> , which no page uses)
Buttons	Every action button uses <code><Button></code> , <code><ButtonLink></code> or <code><ButtonAnchor></code>
Motion	No hover scaling above 1.02 and no bouncy springs; Get Help has no entrance animations (<code>initial={false}</code>)
Contrast	1,685 texts checked; the only alerts are text over photos (which the analysis can't measure) and the "•" separators, now <code>aria-hidden</code>
Responsive	No horizontal scroll at 390/768/1024/1280. Footer and "Join Us!" switch to rows from 1024px

Afterwards, Tailwind's generic grays (`text-gray-700/400` → `pg-navy` / `pg-slate`) and loose icon colors (`#333` , `#acbcb` , `#C0CDD4` , `#8D6B3A`) were also replaced with `currentColor` or tokens.

Intentionally left as loose values: reading widths (`max-w-[480px]` ...) in hero text, and the colors of SVG logos and category palettes.

5.7 Pending

Topic	Detail	Owner
Buttons without a function	"Help me choose" (Get Help), "Take the Quiz" and "Learn more" (Home V1), "Featured" (Ask a Therapist)	Design/development
Social networks	Facebook, Instagram, YouTube and LinkedIn URLs are missing (Vimeo is already linked)	Content
Sample content	Sample events and registration links; courses and resources without their own page open sample templates	Content
Repeated copy	Three home cards repeat "Dive into a wealth of knowledge tailored for parents"	Content
Home pages	Decide between the main home, V1 and V2	Product
State colors	Validate <code>pg-success</code> , <code>pg-warning</code> and <code>pg-error</code> in Figma (already used in badges and notices)	Design